Age-Appropriate Activities

CHICO CAMPOUT FOR COMPASSION * PRINTABLE ACTIVITIES

SHEET A * AGES 6 - 10 * 25 MINUTES

Elementary: What makes a home?

Purpose: Help children understand that people need more than walls and a roof ... they need safety,

stability, connection, and dignity.

Facilitator opening: "People live in different kinds of homes. Some families have to move often, and some people do not have a stable place to stay. No one should be teased or judged because of where they live."

1. Draw a place that helps someone feel safe (10 minutes)

Inside the box, draw or write three things that help a person feel safe and cared for.

2. Talk together (10 minutes)

* Which of these things does everyone need?

* How would you feel if you had to move and did not know where you would sleep?

* What can you do to make someone feel welcome and respected?

3. One kind action (5 minutes)

This week I can show kindness by: _____

Host note: Keep examples gentle, do not ask about children’s personal housing situations, and allow anyone to skip sharing.

CHICO CAMPOUT FOR COMPASSION * PRINTABLE ACTIVITIES

SHEET B * AGES 11 - 13 * 30 - 35 MINUTES

Middle grades: Everyday needs map

Purpose: Understand how stable housing makes ordinary routines easier ... and how communities can

reduce barriers.

1. Choose three everyday needs

Circle three: Sleep | Toilets | Food | Phone charging | Laundry | Transportation | Shower | Storage | School supplies | Quiet place to study

2. Fill in the chart (15 minutes)

NEED When a person has a stable home ... What may become difficult without one?

_____ _____

_____

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_____
_____

_____ _____
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_____
_____

_____ _____
_____

_____
_____

3. Name a community response (10 minutes)

Pick one difficulty. What organization, public facility, friend, service, or housing option might reduce it?

Discuss: Why might it be difficult to keep a job or attend school when basic routines become unpredictable? Do not assume a participant's housing situation.

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SHEET C * AGES 14 - 17 * 35 - 45 MINUTES

Teens: Decisions without easy answers

Purpose: Learn to recognize real-world constraints and ask what practical options are missing. The

fictional situations are for analysis ... not role-play.

Read one fictional situation per small group (10 minutes)

SITUATION 1 * Work hours

A retail worker ends an evening shift after a shelter's latest admission time. The worker has income but cannot find a room within budget.

SITUATION 2 * Keeping family together

A parent is offered a temporary arrangement that cannot accommodate their child or meet the family's transportation needs.

SITUATION 3 * School stability

A student is staying temporarily with relatives. The commute and uncertainty make attendance and homework harder.

SITUATION 4 * Belongings and documents

An adult has no safe storage for work clothes, identification, or medication and must travel to

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appointments across town.

Questions (20 minutes)

* Which needs are immediate? Which problems are caused by a missing resource rather than a poor personal decision?

* What options does the person realistically have? What key information is missing?

* What would make this situation easier ... housing, schedule flexibility, safe storage, transit, services, or something else?

Write one specific improvement for Chico (10 minutes)

Facilitator rule: The goal is to notice limited choices, not ask teenagers to guess what homelessness "feels like" or rank who deserves help.

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SHEET D * ADULTS / MIXED GROUPS * 45 MINUTES

Adults: Three perspectives, one community

Purpose: Practice listening without requiring agreement on every policy.

Read three viewpoints, then discuss

Neighbor: "I'm worried about safety, trash, and how usable our neighborhood parks feel."
Person without housing: "I need somewhere safe to sleep and keep my things ... and I don't always have a realistic alternative."
Service provider: "We want to help, but programs have limits and we cannot promise a housing placement to everyone right away."

1. What does each person want? Avoid telling them what they "really" mean. (10 minutes)
2. Identify two shared goals. (10 minutes)
3. List two questions that need facts, not assumptions. (10 minutes)
4. Identify one respectful next step. (10 minutes)

Facilitator: Acknowledge distinct perspectives, but do not require participants to agree with a harmful generalization or abandon their own experience.

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SHEET E * AGES 11+ * 15 - 20 MINUTES

Optional: Listening and language exercise

Purpose: Notice the difference between a fact, an assumption, and a respectful question.

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Discuss each sentence. What is observed? What is assumed? How might the speaker ask a better question?

Statement Observed fact or interpretation?

Better question to ask

"Everyone on the street refuses help." _____

_____

_____

_____

"Moving tents means fewer people are homeless."

_____

_____

_____

_____

"People in shelters have no problems." _____

_____

_____

_____

"Our neighborhood feels less safe." _____

_____

_____

_____

Debrief: What words could help us talk about a difficult community issue while still recognizing the dignity of all neighbors?

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SHEET F * ANY AGE (ADAPT AS NEEDED)

Reflection: What changed for you?

Complete individually, with a partner, or as a closing circle. Sharing is optional.

One thing I learned today ...

One assumption I want to reconsider ...

One question I still have ...

One way I could treat a neighbor with more dignity ...

For overnight participants: What could you stop doing tomorrow that someone without a safe home cannot simply stop? (Keep the focus on differences, not equivalence.)

End with this: "Our night was temporary. What we learned can stay with us."

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VIDEO DISCUSSION GUIDE

Chico Campout for Compassion 2026 | Optional host resource | November 14, 2026

These videos are optional conversation starters, not an assigned curriculum. Hosts can choose one short selection or a segment that fits their group. Every link goes to the original publisher. Titles and publisher pages were checked, but full videos were not screened or assessed for ratings, length, or accessibility. Watch each selection first, particularly before showing it to minors.

Suggestions by age

Ages 6-10: Skip documentary videos unless a parent/educator personally reviews a suitable excerpt. Use the existing drawing, kindness, and home-safety activities instead.

Ages 11-13: Consider only an adult-previewed, non-graphic excerpt from OrgCode's "Can You Tell Who is HOMELESS?" Pair it with respectful questions; no forced personal disclosures.

Ages 14-17: Try person-first language, teen and family housing topics, or a pre-screened firsthand story. Offer a non-video alternative and a break option.

Adults, church groups, service clubs, neighborhood groups: Explore dignity, shared values, housing affordability, shelter choices, and local responses to encampments. Older teens can join selected adult discussions with appropriate guidance.

A simple 25-35 minute discussion format

5 minutes before: Establish respectful ground rules. Ask what participants already believe or wonder about the topic. Explain that no single story speaks for everyone.

5-15 minutes: Watch one video or excerpt. Do not film audience reactions or ask participants to role-play someone's suffering.

10-15 minutes after: Ask what surprised them, what they still question, and what respectful action they could take locally.

Distinguish personal experience from evidence and policy claims.

Important: Participants may have personal experience with housing loss. Allow people to pass, take a break, or contribute privately. Never require participants or guest speakers to disclose traumatic experiences.

Curated videos and discussion prompts

Language and belonging

Can You Tell Who is HOMELESS?
OrgCode | Ages 11-13+ (preview first)

Ask: What assumptions do we make about who is homeless? What might we be missing?

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Facilitator note: Screen for developmental fit

Why PERSON-FIRST Language is Important.
OrgCode | Teens 14+ / adults

Ask: How can our words describe a situation without defining the whole person?

Facilitator note: Review language before screening

https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/npm7wshpjrcjgdlp5apd5janx3jmrw
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/wsahzesjchlhj8r373zjgm7ft5y5cy

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The Missing Piece in Ending Homelessness: Shared Values
OrgCode | Adults / mixed community groups

Ask: What do participants agree on even when they disagree about policy?

Facilitator note: Good for intergenerational adult conversation

Families, youth and housing affordability

Why So Many Teens Are Becoming Homeless
OrgCode | Teens 14+ / youth leaders

Ask: What kinds of support might prevent a young person from losing a safe place to live?

Facilitator note: Youth housing and family topics may be sensitive

The Reality of Family Homelessness
OrgCode | Older teens / adults

Ask: Why can family homelessness be difficult for neighbors and schools to notice?

Facilitator note: Screen for distressing subject matter

Arleen: A Mother’s Fight for Stability in America’s Hidden Homeless Crisis
Invisible People | Older teens / adults

Ask: What becomes harder for children and parents when stable housing is missing?

Facilitator note: Family instability; consider participants’ own experiences

Cheri - Homeless Senior Living in Hotel
Invisible People | Adults / community groups

Ask: How can people working or receiving benefits still be unable to afford housing?

Facilitator note: Housing insecurity and disability

Why So Many Seniors Are Becoming Homeless
OrgCode | Adults / church groups

Ask: What would it take for older residents on fixed incomes to remain safely housed?

Facilitator note: Discuss compassion and practical assistance

Shelter options and meaningful choice

Why Homeless Services Fail Without Choice
OrgCode | Adults / service organizations

Ask: What makes an available service workable for one person but unworkable for another?

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Facilitator note: Avoid asking people to disclose personal trauma

Melissa: Why Homeless Couples Choose the Streets Over Shelter in Seattle
Invisible People | Older teens 16+ / adults

Ask: How might a shelter's requirements affect someone deciding whether a bed is suitable?

Facilitator note: Pre-screen: long-term street homelessness, relationship separation

Housing: Human Right or Reward?
OrgCode | Adults / service clubs

Ask: What obligations do community members believe come with housing and public support?

Facilitator note: Invite respectful disagreement; do not require consensus

https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/29rnf5pc36ammyk3amwljabjep2h9e
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/jxj9yyrw8cs6f7mcfpgrr3lw2xwpn2
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/ez2gag84azet7lfkw8t5csranjlz6s
https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/hidden-homeless-mother-arleen-family-hotel-crisis/
https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/cheri-homeless-senior-st-louis/
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/h6c3tbmlalw47jfxshejesawwj95ra
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/pmsgl34l5cdll7t34mggws3yhnr9hl
https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/melissa-why-homeless-couples-choose-the-streets-over-shelter-in-seattle/
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/92pcbc959676emy394wy6t3cb6fxas

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Neighborhoods and public responses

Homeless ENCAMPMENT Response 101
OrgCode | Adults / civic groups

Ask: What would a successful encampment response look like for residents and for people displaced?

Facilitator note: Policy discussion, not a youth simulation

Skid Row Homeless Sweeps Make Homelessness Worse
Invisible People | Adults / older teens 16+

Ask: What happens to people and belongings when an encampment is cleared? How should outcomes be measured?

Facilitator note: Distressing displacement footage; screen in advance

Don't Want Homelessness Services in Your Backyard? Front yard it is.
OrgCode | Adults / neighborhood groups

Ask: What specific neighborhood concerns can be addressed while maintaining dignity?

Facilitator note: Encourage questions instead of dismissive labels

Kim: From Freezing in a Tent to the Safety of a Home
Invisible People | Older teens / adults

Ask: How might we measure progress beyond the number of camps cleared?

Facilitator note: References to displacement, citations, and severe weather

Source and usage notes

Watch and share from the original OrgCode or Invisible People page. Links are curated pointers, not endorsements of

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every statement in a recording. Copyright stays with the creators; do not download, edit, re-upload, or publicly project

videos contrary to publisher terms or venue licensing rules. Local host approval and accessibility checks are recommended.

Publisher libraries: OrgCode videos | Invisible People videos

The resource collection is independently curated for Chico Campout for Compassion, not published by, endorsed by, or affiliated with OrgCode
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https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/hc7gt6d6kkkdsk8kgecmhw2k643mt8
https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/skid-row-homeless-sweeps-make-homelessness-worse/
https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/jlaljxrcd5ht4zrw2smhle7p4pcw4g
https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/kim-from-freezing-in-a-tent-to-the-safety-of-a-home/
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